

WORKING DOCUMENT · 28 SEPTEMBER 2026

Three routes. Three type directions. One recommendation.

Exploration boards for HCO — High Country Observations. They are here to choose a direction, not to finish one. Once a route and a type direction are approved, the chosen identity is refined, built into a system and delivered as the five-page identity pack.

01-02

What we heard

03-08

Routes 1, 2 and 3

09

Typography directions

10-11

Recommendation and decisions

WHAT WE HEARD

A practical business that shows up, learns the operation and says what to do next.

THE WORK

Business & operations — regulatory and compliance research, business decisions, contracts and vendors, markets and supply chains.

Field & property intelligence — drone mapping, crop-health observations, farm and ranch mapping, repeat monitoring and clear practical reports.

For farmers, ranchers and agricultural business owners and operators. It has to feel straightforward to an owner-operator and credible in front of a larger organisation.

THE TERRITORY · GROUNDED INTELLIGENCE

The relationship between seeing the wider system and understanding what is happening on the ground. HCO turns observation into useful judgement and practical next steps. Technology supports that promise; it is not the business.

GROUNDED

CLEAR-SIGHTED

CAPABLE

INDEPENDENT

DIRECT

Internal territory only — not a public tagline.

WHAT THE CURRENT MATERIAL TELLS US

A peak above initials is the category's most common mark, and gold on black reads as luxury or outdoor gear rather than advice.

The flyer's content is strong. Its presentation — generated photography, distressed type, icon sets — undersells it.

Worth keeping: the plain, practical voice, and “Understand systems. Protect people.” as an optional line, not fixed to the logo.

NAMING — TO CONFIRM

The existing logo reads “High Country Observations **Group**”; the flyer uses “...Observations **Consulting**” and “HCO Consulting”. These boards use **HCO** as the principal identifier, **High Country Observations** as the expanded name, and **Consulting** as an optional descriptor.

ROUTE 1 · CUSTOM TYPOGRAPHIC

High Bar

HCO High Country
Observations

THE IDEA

A custom-drawn HCO in which the crossbar of the H sits high — the horizon as you see it from high ground, with more land in view than sky. That one line becomes the system: layouts hang their content below the same high horizon, and photographs are cropped the same way.

MOST IMPORTANT WEAKNESS

The idea lives in a single detail. Without the system around it, some people will simply see a well-drawn HCO, and a crossbar pushed any higher starts to look like a period mannerism.

REVERSE



COMPACT MARK



SCREEN SIZES



16 PX x6
ACTUAL 16 · 24 · 32 PX

HCO
SIGNATURE AT 20 PX HIGH

PRINT SIZES (ACTUAL)

HCO High Country
Observations
SIGNATURE AT 30 MM WIDE

H H
COMPACT MARK AT 8 MM AND 5 MM HIGH

ROUTE 1 · HIGH BAR

In use

HCO

ASSESSMENT REPORT

Field & property intelligence

Field & Operations Review

01

Observations

02

Operational priorities

03

Recommended next steps

Prepared for
[Client name]

Property
[Property name]

Visit
[Month Year]

TYPE DIRECTION

A — Clear authority · Instrument Sans (one family)

Field & Operations Review

Operational priorities

We show up, learn the operation, identify the issue, and give you practical options for what to do next. Each observation is tied to a location, a date and a recommended next step. *Recommended next steps* close every section.

OBSERVATION 03 · NORTH BLOCK		PRIORITY 1
Area mapped		148.6 ha
Mean NDVI, this visit		0.72
Change since last visit		-0.06
Priority areas identified		3

ILLUSTRATIVE FIGURES — NOT PROJECT DATA

GRAPHIC LANGUAGE

The high horizon

A single rule set at the crossbar's height — 28.5% down from the top of any format. Context sits above it (who, where, when); the ground sits below (observations, priorities, next steps). Photography follows the same rule: a high horizon, more ground than sky.

ROUTE 2 · LAND AND OBSERVATION

Rise



THE IDEA

One line, read two ways. From above it is a boundary between fields; from the side it is ground rising to high country. The symbol is a change of perspective — the map and the ground, the plan and the section — which is exactly what HCO's work brings together.

MOST IMPORTANT WEAKNESS

Abstract geometry is easily misread: at a glance the line can look like a step chart or a stair, and rising-line marks are common in consulting. It needs the two-tone version or real context to read as land.

REVERSE



COMPACT MARK



SCREEN SIZES



16 PX x6

ACTUAL 16 · 24 · 32 PX



SIGNATURE AT 20 PX HIGH

PRINT SIZES (ACTUAL)



SIGNATURE AT 30 MM WIDE



COMPACT MARK AT 8 MM AND 5 MM HIGH

ROUTE 2 · RISE

In use



Field & Operations Review

[Property name] · [Month Year]

01
Observations

02
Operational priorities

03
Recommended next steps

TYPE DIRECTION

C — Field precision · IBM Plex Sans + IBM Plex Mono

Field & Operations Review

Operational priorities

We show up, learn the operation, identify the issue, and give you practical options for what to do next. Each observation is tied to a location, a date and a recommended next step.

OBSERVATION 03 · NORTH BLOCK		PRIORITY 1
Area mapped		148.6 ha
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Priority areas identified		3

ILLUSTRATIVE FIGURES — NOT PROJECT DATA

GRAPHIC LANGUAGE

The dividing line

The rise line divides formats into two fields — the plan above, the ground below — and pairs images the same way: an aerial view with a view from the ground. On maps the same line weight marks boundaries and change between visits.

ROUTE 3 · ALTERNATIVE INTERPRETATION

The Point

HCO.

THE IDEA

HCO's real product is clarity: after the visit you know what the issue is and what to do next. The identity is plain-spoken — a confident serif name closed by a square point, the same point that marks each observation on a map and ends each recommendation.

MOST IMPORTANT WEAKNESS

Full-stop wordmarks are a familiar device, and a square alone is too generic to own. The compact mark is the weakest of the three, and the serif leans further towards editorial than field.

REVERSE



COMPACT MARK



SCREEN SIZES



16 PX ×6

ACTUAL 16 · 24 · 32 PX



SIGNATURE AT 20 PX HIGH

PRINT SIZES (ACTUAL)

HCO.

SIGNATURE AT 30 MM WIDE

H. H.

COMPACT MARK AT 8 MM AND 5 MM HIGH

ROUTE 3 · THE POINT

In use

HCO.

Field & Operations
Review.

- 01 Observations
- 02 Operational priorities
- 03 Recommended next steps

Prepared for
[Client name]

Property
[Property name]

Visit
[Month Year]

TYPE DIRECTION

B — Editorial judgement · Newsreader +
Public Sans

Field &
Operations
Review

Operational priorities

We show up, learn the operation,
identify the issue, and give you
practical options for what to do next.
Each observation is tied to a location, a
date and a recommended next step.

OBSERVATION 03 · NORTH BLOCK PRIORITY 1

Area mapped	148.6 ha
Mean NDVI, this visit	0.72
Change since last visit	-0.06
Priority areas identified	3

ILLUSTRATIVE FIGURES — NOT PROJECT DATA

GRAPHIC LANGUAGE

The square point

One small square does three jobs: it closes
the name, it marks each observation
location on a map, and it flags each
recommended next step. Reserved for
things that need attention — never
decoration.

TYPOGRAPHY · IDENTICAL CONTENT, THREE DIRECTIONS

Choose a voice, not a font

A — CLEAR AUTHORITY

Instrument Sans · Regular, Italic, Medium, SemiBold, condensed widths — one family

HCO

Field & Operations Review

Operational priorities

We show up, learn the operation, identify the issue, and give you practical options for what to do next.
Understand systems. Protect people.

FIELD OBSERVATIONS	RECOMMENDED NEXT STEPS
Area mapped	148.6 ha
Change since last visit	−0.06
Figures	0123456789

IN PLACE OF: SÖHNE, NEUE HAAS GROTESK, GT AMERICA (NOT REACHABLE HERE)

B — EDITORIAL JUDGEMENT

Newsreader (display + text) · Public Sans (labels, data)

HCO

Field & Operations Review

Operational priorities

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Understand systems. Protect people.

FIELD OBSERVATIONS	RECOMMENDED NEXT STEPS
Area mapped	148.6 ha
Change since last visit	−0.06
Figures	0123456789

IN PLACE OF: TIEMPOS OR SUISSSE WORKS WITH GRAPHIK OR SÖHNE

C — FIELD PRECISION

IBM Plex Sans · IBM Plex Mono (labels, data)

HCO

Field & Operations Review

Operational priorities

We show up, learn the operation, identify the issue, and give you practical options for what to do next.
Understand systems. Protect people.

FIELD OBSERVATIONS	RECOMMENDED NEXT STEPS
Area mapped	148.6 ha
Change since last visit	−0.06
Figures	0123456789

IN PLACE OF: SELECTED ON MERIT FROM THE OPEN INVENTORY

All three use open-licence (SIL OFL) families verified to render in this environment; your licensed premium families could not be reached. Real italics and tabular lining figures throughout; no synthetic bold or stretched type.

EVALUATION · INTERNAL WORKING VIEW

How the routes compare

	ROUTE 1 · HIGH BAR	ROUTE 2 · RISE	ROUTE 3 · THE POINT
BUSINESS RELEVANCE	A direct translation of the name; plain enough for a truck door or a lender's desk.	Closest to the field work — plan and section; says less about the advisory half.	Captures the advisory value; says least about land and the field.
DISTINCTIVENESS	A raised crossbar is rare in the category and ownable without a symbol.	Clean, but steps and rising lines are common forms.	Full-stop names and serif wordmarks are familiar.
TYPOGRAPHIC CRAFT	Drawn lettering gives control of every join and space; needs a refinement pass.	A well-set typeface rather than drawn lettering.	Handsome serif; point spacing needs care; not custom.
SMALL-SCALE PERFORMANCE	The H holds at 16 px; the raised bar is still legible at 24 px.	Holds at 24 px; at 16 px the line starts to close — needs a small-size cut.	“H.” reads as an initial; at 16 px the point is a pixel or two.
POTENTIAL FOR A WIDER SYSTEM	One measure organises reports, vehicles, web and photography.	Strong for maps and paired images; risk of repetitive dividers.	Useful markers in maps and lists; the rest is typographic voice.

RECOMMENDATION

Route 1 — High Bar,
with type direction A

It is the most distinctive without leaning on a symbol, it survives at the smallest sizes, and its one idea generates the most useful system — for the advisory half of the business as much as the field half. The weakness is addressed in refinement: draw the letters properly (overshoots, C aperture, spacing), keep the crossbar at 71.5% and no higher, and make the high horizon a working rule in every layout so the detail has a reason to be noticed.

DECISIONS NEEDED

Before the identity pack is built

1 · ROUTE

Approve Route 1 (recommended), choose Route 2 or 3, or redirect. Routes will not be merged; once one is approved its mark and idea are locked and only the craft is refined.

2 · TYPOGRAPHY

Approve direction A (recommended), B or C — and decide how the final type will be licensed (right).

3 · NAMING

Confirm “Group” or “Consulting”. Until then: HCO, High Country Observations, and Consulting as an optional descriptor.

4 · CONTACT DETAILS

The phone number and the email address on the flyer are not used anywhere in this work. The address is on a default Microsoft domain; a branded domain is worth setting up before release.

FONT ACCESS · WHAT WAS FOUND

This work runs in a remote Linux environment, not on your computer, so your installed fonts are not visible to it. None of Söhne, GT America, Graphik, Neue Haas Grotesk, Suisse Int'l or Works, Founders Grotesk or Tiempos is available here. Neue Haas Grotesk appears in the connected Adobe Fonts library, but Adobe's font servers are blocked by this environment's network policy, so it cannot be rendered or checked here.

The directions shown use open-licence families that were verified to render here.

TWO WAYS FORWARD

a · Approve the open-licence type. It can be embedded in PDFs, used on a website and installed on HCO's own computers at no cost — the simplest handover.

b · Use a licensed family. Name it and provide approved access — for example, run the documented build on your own machine where it is installed. The client would need its own licence for web and office use; desktop availability does not grant that.